Every pricing objection from every perspective

AcquisitionOS — AI-Powered Client Acquisition System

Pricing Q&A; — Every Objection, Every Perspective

This document prepares you for every pricing-related question from investors, clients, users, and partners. Answers are honest about where the pricing is competitive and where it's not.

Current Pricing Structure

Plan	Monthly	Yearly	Credits	Key Features
Starter	FREE	FREE	50	Discovery, scoring, basic outreach, 1 niche
Pro	$29	$290	750	Autopilot, multi-channel, 5 niches, CRM
Elite	$99	$990	2,000	BI, sequences, unlimited niches, priority
Enterprise	Custom	Custom	Custom	Dedicated infra, SLA, white-label

Credit Pack	Price	Credits	Cost/Credit
Starter Pack	$10	250	$0.040
Growth Pack	$18	500	$0.036
Scale Pack	$30	1,000	$0.030
Bulk Pack	$60	2,500	$0.024

Investor Pricing Questions

Q: Is $29/month too cheap to build a real business?

A: At $29/month Pro with ~70% gross margin (credit cost ~$8.7/user for AI + email), we need ~690 paying Pro customers for $20K MRR (break-even for 2-person team + infrastructure). At $99/month Elite, we need ~200 customers. The low price is a deliberate market-entry strategy — it's the wedge into the 50M+ Indian SMBs that can't afford $99/user Apollo. Pricing increases as the product proves value: Pro → $39/mo after first 500 customers, Elite → $149/mo after first 200. Annual contracts lock in the lower rate and improve cash flow.

Q: What's your gross margin?

A: Estimated 70% at Pro, 75% at Elite. Costs: AI API calls (~$0.01-0.03/lead discovered + analyzed), email sending (~$0.001/email via Gmail SMTP, ~$0 for first 2,000/day), database/storage (~$0.50/user on Postgres), payment processing (2.9% + $0.30 per Stripe transaction). At Pro ($29): ~$8.7 cost, $20.3 profit. At Elite ($99): ~$24.75 cost, $74.25 profit. These are estimates — real costs will be measured once paying users are active.

Q: What's your LTV (Lifetime Value)?

A: Unknown — no paying customers yet to measure churn. Industry benchmarks for SMB SaaS: 8% monthly churn, 12-month average lifetime. At Pro ($29/mo, 12-month LTV): $348 revenue, $245 cost = $103 LTV. At Elite ($99/mo, 18-month LTV — lower churn at higher tier): $1,782 revenue, $445 cost = $1,337 LTV. With annual contracts (15% discount, 24-month commitment): Pro LTV = $580, Elite LTV = $2,029. Target blended LTV: $400 by month 12.

Q: What's your unit economics?

A: Target CAC: $15-30 (content marketing + product-led growth). LTV: $400 (blended). LTV:CAC ratio: 13:1 to 27:1 (healthy is >3:1). Payback period: 1-2 months. These are projections, not measured data. The risk: if CAC is higher than $50 (paid acquisition in competitive markets), payback extends to 3-4 months and we need more runway. Mitigation: product-led growth (free Starter plan) keeps CAC low.

Q: Why credits instead of just per-seat pricing?

A: Per-seat pricing (like Apollo $99/user/month) punishes small teams — a solo foundator pays the same as a 10-person sales team. Credits align cost with VALUE: a solo founder who discovers 100 leads and contacts 50 pays less than an agency doing 1,000 leads and 500 contacts. It's fairer and more scalable. The downside: credits are harder to explain than '$X/month per user'. We mitigate with clear onboarding (showing exactly what 50/750/2000 credits buys).

Q: How does pricing compare to competitors?

A: See competitor pricing table below. We're 3-10x cheaper than the closest comparable tool. But honestly: competitors offer more data (Apollo: 275M contacts), better integrations (HubSpot: 1,000+ integrations), and more mature features. Our lower price reflects a less mature product targeting a different market segment (SMBs vs enterprise).

Competitor Pricing Comparison

Tool	Entry Price	Mid-tier	Enterprise	Pricing Model
AcquisitionOS	FREE	$29/mo	$99/mo+	Credit-based
Apollo.io	$49/user/mo	$99/user/mo	$149/user/mo	Per-seat
HubSpot Starter	$20/mo	$100/mo	$1,200+/mo	Per-seat + contacts
Outreach.io	N/A	~$100/user/mo	~$180/user/mo	Per-seat (annual only)
Clay.com	~$100/mo	~$300/mo	Custom	Per-seat + credits
11x.ai	~$500/mo	~$1,000/mo	Custom	Per-seat (AI SDR)
ZoomInfo	~$200/user/mo	~$400/user/mo	Custom	Per-seat + credits
Lemlist	$39/user/mo	$59/user/mo	$99/user/mo	Per-seat
Smartlead	~$30/mo	~$70/mo	~$140/mo	Per-mailbox
LinkedIn Sales Nav	$99/user/mo	$149/user/mo	Custom	Per-seat

Client Pricing Questions

Q: $29/month seems expensive for a small business.

A: Compare: a small business currently spends 15+ hours/week (worth $300+ at $20/hour) on manual lead finding and outreach. At $29/month, AcquisitionOS replaces that work for less than $1/day. If it saves even 2 hours/week, it pays for itself 5x over. The Starter plan is free — try it first, upgrade only when you see value.

Q: Why should I pay $99/month when Lemlist is $39?

A: Lemlist sends emails — you still have to find the leads, write the messages, and track replies manually. AcquisitionOS discovers leads, scores them, writes messages, sends them, tracks replies, and surfaces what needs attention — automatically. Comparing us to Lemlist is like comparing a self-driving car to a steering wheel. But honestly: if you already have your lead list and just need to send emails, Lemlist is cheaper for that specific task.

Q: Can I get a discount?

A: Annual contracts: 15% off (2 months free). 6-month: 10% off. 3-month: 5% off. Referral: 15% recurring commission for each customer you refer (as long as they stay active). Agency reseller: 25% recurring commission. Non-profit: 50% off. We don't discount monthly plans — the value is already priced for SMBs.

Q: What happens if I run out of credits mid-campaign?

A: Two options: (1) Buy a credit add-on pack ($10 for 250 credits, instant), (2) Upgrade to the next plan (prorated for the current billing period). Credits never expire while your subscription is active. If you consistently run out, the system recommends upgrading based on your usage patterns.

Q: Do I pay per lead or per month?

A: Both. The monthly subscription includes a credit allowance. Credits are consumed as the system works (discovery, analysis, outreach). If you consume all credits before the month ends, you buy add-on packs or wait for the next billing cycle. This prevents bill shock — you never pay more than your subscription + explicit add-on purchases.

Q: Is there a free trial of the paid plans?

A: The Starter plan (50 credits) is free forever — no credit card, no time limit. For Pro/Elite features, there's a 14-day free trial (credit card required, cancel anytime). If you cancel during the trial, you're not charged. [Note: trial system is coded but not yet active — implement before launch.]

Q: Why is Enterprise 'custom' pricing? Just give me a number.

A: Enterprise pricing depends on: number of users, credit volume, dedicated infrastructure requirements, custom integrations, SLA level, and contract length. Ballpark: $500-2,000/month for 10-50 users with dedicated support. Annual contracts with 20-30% discount. White-label deployment: $5,000+/month. We say 'custom' because each enterprise has different needs — a fixed price would overcharge some and undercharge others.

User Pricing Questions

Q: What exactly do I get for free?

A: 50 credits (enough for ~30 lead discoveries, 10 analyses, 10 outreach messages), 1 niche, basic discovery from Google Maps and AI Search, lead scoring, email outreach, access to the CRM dashboard, email/password + OTP login. No credit card required. No time limit. The free plan is designed to prove value before you pay.

Q: How many credits does each action use?

A: Lead discovery: ~1 credit/lead. Lead analysis + scoring: ~2 credits. Business website research: ~5 credits. AI outreach message generation: ~1 credit. Email send: ~1 credit. Meeting scheduling: ~3 credits. So a typical flow (discover → analyze → generate message → send email) = ~5 credits per lead. 50 free credits = ~10 leads through the full pipeline.

Q: Will my credits expire?

A: No — as long as your subscription is active (including the free Starter plan), credits don't expire. If you cancel a paid subscription, remaining credits are available for 90 days. After 90 days of inactivity, credits are forfeited.

Q: Can I get a refund?

A: Monthly subscriptions: refund within 7 days if you haven't used more than 50% of your credits. Annual subscriptions: prorated refund within 30 days. Credit add-on packs: non-refundable once consumed. If the system was down for >24 hours, we extend your subscription by the downtime + 7 days bonus.

Partner Pricing Questions

Q: I'm an agency. Can I resell this to my clients?

A: Yes. Reseller partnership: 25% recurring commission on every customer you refer, for as long as they stay subscribed. White-label: your branding, your domain, your pricing — we power the backend. Minimum commitment: $1,000/month (reseller) or $5,000/month (white-label). You set the price for your clients; we charge you a wholesale rate (50% off published prices).

Q: Can I get an exclusive territory?

A: For white-label partners with $10,000+/month commitment: yes, geographic exclusivity (e.g., exclusive reseller rights for a state or country) for 12-24 months, renewable based on performance. For standard resellers: non-exclusive. We protect partners who deliver volume.